

2 Differentiation

3 Differentiation II

4 Differentiation III

Differentiation



Mathematics
and Statistics

$$\int_M d\omega = \int_{\partial M} \omega$$

Mathematics 3A03 Real Analysis I

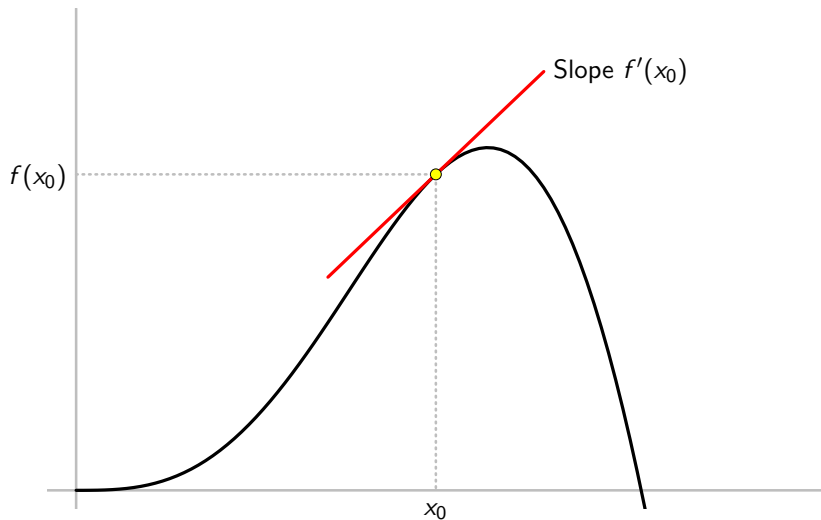
Instructor: David Earn

Lecture 2
Differentiation
Thursday 8 January 2026

Announcements

- Slides are posted on the course website:
<https://ms.mcmaster.ca/earn/3A03>
- Lecture recordings are posted on Avenue-to-Learn

The Derivative



The Derivative

Definition (Derivative)

Let f be defined on an interval I and let $x_0 \in I$. The **derivative** of f at x_0 , denoted by $f'(x_0)$, is defined as

$$f'(x_0) = \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0},$$

provided either that this limit exists or is infinite. If $f'(x_0)$ is finite we say that f is **differentiable** at x_0 . If f is differentiable at every point of a set $E \subseteq I$, we say that f is differentiable on E . If E is all of I , we simply say that f is a **differentiable function**.

Note: “Differentiable” and “a derivative exists” always mean that the derivative is finite.

The Derivative

Example

$f(x) = x^2$. Find $f'(2)$.

$$f'(2) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} \frac{x^2 - 4}{x - 2} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} \frac{(x + 2)(x - 2)}{x - 2} = \lim_{x \rightarrow 2} x + 2 = 4$$

Note:

- In the first two limits, we must have $x \neq 2$.
- But in the third limit, we just plug in $x = 2$.
- Two things are equal, but in one $x \neq 2$ and in the other $x = 2$.
- Good illustration of why it is important to define the meaning of limits rigorously.

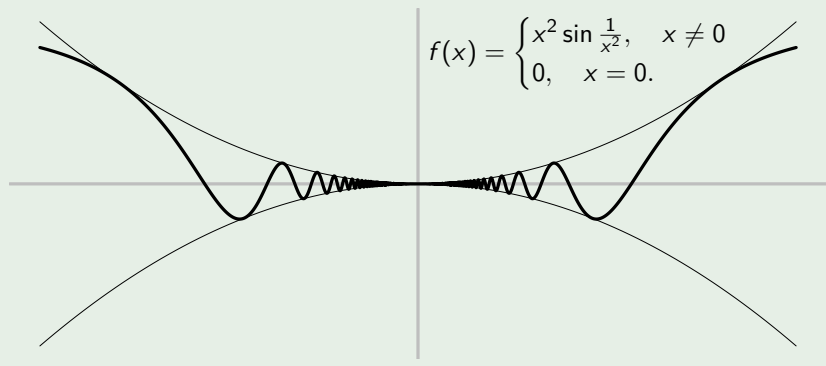
Poll

- Go to
https://www.childsmath.ca/childsa/forms/main_login.php
- Click on **Math 3A03**
- Click on **Take Class Poll**
- Fill in poll **Derivatives: Differentiable at 0**
- .

The Derivative

Example

Let f be defined in a neighbourhood I of 0, and suppose $|f(x)| \leq x^2$ for all $x \in I$. Is f necessarily differentiable at 0? e.g.,



The Derivative

Example (Trapping principle)

Suppose $f(x) = \begin{cases} x^2 \sin \frac{1}{x^2}, & x \neq 0 \\ 0, & x = 0. \end{cases}$ Then:

$$\forall x \neq 0 : \left| \frac{f(x) - f(0)}{x - 0} \right| = \left| \frac{f(x)}{x} \right| = \left| \frac{x^2 \sin \frac{1}{x^2}}{x} \right| = \left| x \sin \frac{1}{x^2} \right| \leq |x|$$

Therefore:

$$|f'(0)| = \left| \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x) - f(0)}{x - 0} \right| = \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \left| \frac{f(x) - f(0)}{x - 0} \right| \leq \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} |x| = 0.$$

$\therefore f$ is differentiable at 0 and $f'(0) = 0$. □

The Derivative

Definition (One-sided derivatives)

Let f be defined on an interval I and let $x_0 \in I$. The **right-hand derivative** of f at x_0 , denoted by $f'_+(x_0)$, is the limit

$$f'_+(x_0) = \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^+} \frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0},$$

provided either that this one-sided limit exists or is infinite.

Similarly, the **left-hand derivative** of f at x_0 , denoted by $f'_-(x_0)$, is the limit

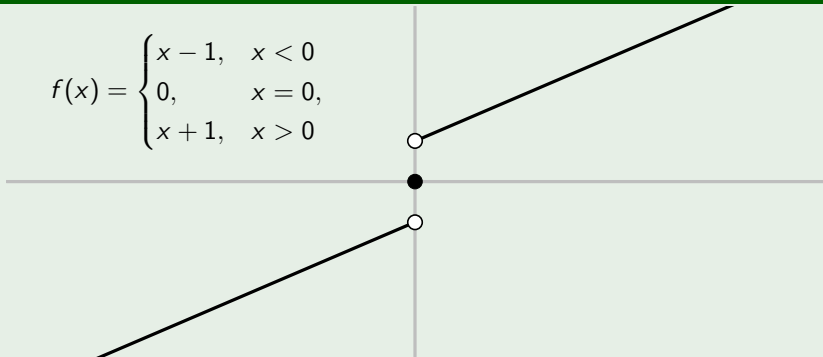
$$f'_-(x_0) = \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0^-} \frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0}.$$

Note: If x_0 is not an endpoint of the interval I then f is differentiable at x_0 iff $f'_+(x_0) = f'_-(x_0) \neq \pm\infty$.

The Derivative

Example

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} x - 1, & x < 0 \\ 0, & x = 0, \\ x + 1, & x > 0 \end{cases}$$



- Same slope from left and right. Why isn't f differentiable???
- $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^-} f'(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} f'(x) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} f'(x) = 1.$
- $f'_-(0) = f'_+(0) = f'(0) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(x) - f(0)}{x - 0} = \infty.$

The Derivative

- Higher derivatives: we write
 - $f'' = (f')'$ if f' is differentiable;
 - $f^{(n+1)} = (f^{(n)})'$ if $f^{(n)}$ is differentiable.
- Other standard notation for derivatives:

$$\frac{df}{dx} = f'(x)$$

$$D = \frac{d}{dx}$$

$$D^n f(x) = \frac{d^n f}{dx^n} = f^{(n)}(x)$$

REMINDER: Algebra of limits

Theorem (Algebraic operations on limits of sequences)

Suppose $\{s_n\}$ and $\{t_n\}$ are *convergent sequences* and $C \in \mathbb{R}$.

1 $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} C s_n = C \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} s_n \right) ;$

2 $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (s_n + t_n) = \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} s_n \right) + \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} t_n \right) ;$

3 $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (s_n - t_n) = \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} s_n \right) - \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} t_n \right) ;$

4 $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} (s_n t_n) = \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} s_n \right) \left(\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} t_n \right) ;$

5 if $t_n \neq 0$ for all n and $\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} t_n \neq 0$ then

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \left(\frac{s_n}{t_n} \right) = \frac{\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} s_n}{\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} t_n} .$$

(TBB §2.7, and problem 2.7.4)

REMINDER: Algebra of limits

Theorem (Algebraic operations on limits of functions)

Suppose $f, g : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, $x_0 \in \mathbb{R}$, the limits as $x \rightarrow x_0$ of $f(x)$ and $g(x)$ both exist, and $C \in \mathbb{R}$.

$$1 \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} C f(x) = C \left(\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) \right) ;$$

$$2 \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (f(x) + g(x)) = \left(\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) \right) + \left(\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} g(x) \right) ;$$

$$3 \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (f(x) - g(x)) = \left(\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) \right) - \left(\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} g(x) \right) ;$$

$$4 \quad \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (f(x)g(x)) = \left(\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) \right) \left(\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} g(x) \right) ;$$

$$5 \quad \text{if } g(x) \neq 0 \text{ for } x \in (x_0 - \delta, x_0 + \delta) \text{ for some } \delta > 0, \text{ and} \\ \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} g(x) \neq 0 \text{ then } \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \left(\frac{f(x)}{g(x)} \right) = \frac{\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x)}{\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} g(x)} .$$

The Derivative

Theorem (Differentiable $\implies$ continuous)

If f is defined in a neighbourhood I of x_0 and f is differentiable at x_0 then f is continuous at x_0 .

Proof.

Must show $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = f(x_0)$, i.e., $\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (f(x) - f(x_0)) = 0$.

$$\begin{aligned}\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (f(x) - f(x_0)) &= \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \left(\frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0} \times (x - x_0) \right) \\ &= \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} \left(\frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0} \right) \times \lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} (x - x_0) \\ &= f'(x_0) \times 0 = 0,\end{aligned}$$

where we have used the theorem on the algebra of limits. □



Mathematics
and Statistics

$$\int_M d\omega = \int_{\partial M} \omega$$

Mathematics 3A03 Real Analysis I

Instructor: David Earn

Lecture 3
Differentiation II
Friday 9 January 2026

Last time...

- Definition of the derivative.
 - Example: Trapping Principle
- Defined one-sided derivatives
 - Example
- Proved differentiable $\implies$ continuous.

More on the derivative

Theorem (Algebra of derivatives)

Suppose f and g are defined on an interval I and $x_0 \in I$. If f and g are differentiable at x_0 then $f + g$ and fg are differentiable at x_0 . If, in addition, $g(x_0) \neq 0$ then f/g is differentiable at x_0 . Under these conditions:

- 1** $(cf)'(x_0) = cf'(x_0)$ for all $c \in \mathbb{R}$;
- 2** $(f + g)'(x_0) = (f' + g')(x_0)$;
- 3** $(fg)'(x_0) = (f'g + fg')(x_0)$;
- 4** $\left(\frac{f}{g}\right)'(x_0) = \left(\frac{gf' - fg'}{g^2}\right)(x_0) \quad (g(x_0) \neq 0).$

(TBB [Theorem 7.7](#), p. 408)

The Derivative

Theorem (Chain rule)

Suppose f is defined in a neighbourhood U of x_0 and g is defined in a neighbourhood V of $f(x_0)$ such that $f(U) \subseteq V$. If f is differentiable at x_0 and g is differentiable at $f(x_0)$ then the composite function $h = g \circ f$ is differentiable at x_0 and

$$h'(x_0) = (g \circ f)'(x_0) = g'(f(x_0))f'(x_0).$$

Informally, if $y = f(x)$ and $z = g(y)$ then $\frac{dz}{dx} = \frac{dz}{dy} \frac{dy}{dx}$.

(TBB §7.3.2, p. 411)

Why the chain rule is plausible

The derivative of $g \circ f$ at x_0 is the limit as $x \rightarrow x_0$ of the difference quotient

$$\frac{g(f(x)) - g(f(x_0))}{x - x_0} = \frac{g(f(x)) - g(f(x_0))}{f(x) - f(x_0)} \cdot \frac{f(x) - f(x_0)}{x - x_0} \quad (\spadesuit)$$

Recall: $f'(x_0)$ exists $\implies f$ continuous at x_0
 $\implies f(x) \rightarrow f(x_0)$ as $x \rightarrow x_0$.

Can we take the limit as $x \rightarrow x_0$ and conclude that $(g \circ f)'(x_0) = g'(f(x_0)) \cdot f'(x_0)$?

- What if $f(x) = 0$ for all x ?
- What if f is a constant function?
- What if $f(x) = f(x_0)$ for some $x \neq x_0$?
- Can we use $(\spadesuit)$ to prove the chain rule?

Poll

- Go to
https://www.childsmath.ca/childsa/forms/main_login.php
- Click on **Math 3A03**
- Click on **Take Class Poll**
- Fill in poll **Derivatives: Chain Rule**
- .

REMINDER: limits of functions

Theorem (Equivalence of ε - δ and sequence definitions of limits)

Let $a < x_0 < b$, $I = (a, b)$, and $f : I \setminus \{x_0\} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. Then the following two definitions of

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow x_0} f(x) = L$$

are equivalent:

- 1 for all $\varepsilon > 0$ there exists $\delta > 0$ such that if $0 < |x - x_0| < \delta$ then $|f(x) - L| < \varepsilon$.
- 2 for every sequence $\{x_n\}$ of points in $I \setminus \{x_0\}$,

$$\lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} x_n = x_0 \implies \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} f(x_n) = L.$$

Note: The deleted neighbourhood $(I \setminus \{x_0\})$ can be replaced by any set on which f is defined and x_0 is an accumulation point.

Proof of the chain rule.

- 1 Suppose there is an open interval I , with $x_0 \in I$, and $f(x) \neq f(x_0)$ for all $x \in I \setminus \{x_0\}$. Then we can take the limit $x \rightarrow x_0$ in  and we get the [chain rule](#).
- 2 Next suppose that no open interval like the one hypothesized above exists. Then, in any open interval containing x_0 , there must be at least one point $x \neq x_0$ for which $f(x) = f(x_0)$. Therefore, we can construct a sequence of open intervals I_n , with lengths decreasing to 0, such that each I_n contains x_0 and a point $x_n \neq x_0$ with $f(x_n) = f(x_0)$. Therefore, since $f'(x_0)$ exists, and we recall the [previous slide](#), we can compute $f'(x_0)$ via

$$f'(x_0) = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{f(x_n) - f(x_0)}{x_n - x_0} = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{0}{x_n - x_0} = 0.$$

We can also show that $(g \circ f)'(x_0) = 0$, using the sequence definition on the [previous slide](#). *Try to fill in this last detail*, or look it up (TBB [§7.3.2, p. 411](#)).

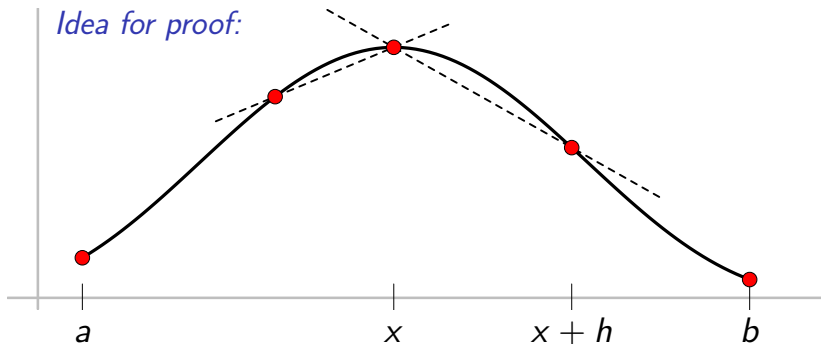
Note: TBB's proof leaves out the proof that $f'(x_0) = 0$ in case 2 above. 

More on the derivative

Theorem (Derivative at local extrema)

Let $f : (a, b) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$. If x is a maximum or minimum point of f in (a, b) , and f is differentiable at x , then $f'(x) = 0$.

Note: f need not be differentiable or even continuous at other points.



More on the derivative

Proof that the derivative vanishes at local extrema.

If f has a local maximum at $x \in (a, b)$, then for sufficiently small $h > 0$ we must have

$$\frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h} \leq 0 \leq \frac{f(x) - f(x-h)}{h}$$

Since f is differentiable at x , it is left and right differentiable at x , so we can evaluate the limits as $h \rightarrow 0$ to obtain

$$f'_+(x) \leq 0 \leq f'_-(x).$$

But since f is differentiable at x , the left and right derivatives must be equal, hence $f'(x) = 0$. □



Mathematics
and Statistics

$$\int_M d\omega = \int_{\partial M} \omega$$

Mathematics 3A03 Real Analysis I

Instructor: David Earn

Lecture 4
Differentiation III
Tuesday 13 January 2026

If you haven't already, please fill in Math 3A03 Survey 1 on childsmath

- Go to https://www.childsmath.ca/childsa/forms/main_login.php
- Click on Math 3A03
- Click on Take Class Poll
- Fill in poll **Survey 1**
- .

Announcements

- In-Class polls: if you do not have a device that enables you to participate in polls in class, or if any other issue prevents you from participating in polls, please let me know by e-mail.
- I will be back in Hamilton on Wednesday night, so Thursday's lecture will be in person in HH-109. The live stream will be via Echo360, which you can access from Avenue or directly via <https://echo360.ca/section/3035896c-301d-4409-b019-e7c97ef4247e/public>
- *Office hours*: Until further notice, I will be available in person in my office on Thursdays after class, *i.e.*, 3:30-4:20pm.
- *TA office hours*: Please do "Survey 2" poll on childsmath

Poll

- Go to
https://www.childsmath.ca/childsa/forms/main_login.php
- Click on **Math 3A03**
- Click on **Take Class Poll**
- Fill in poll **Survey 2**
- .

Course evaluation clarifications

- 5% for participating in at least 80% of in-class polls
- 5% for participating in assignments, based on multiple choice (MC) questions:

$$\text{assignment mark} = \frac{\text{number MC questions answered}}{\text{total number MC questions assigned}}$$

- 20% for midterm test on Thurs 26 February 2026
- 20% for midterm test on Thurs 26 March 2026
- 50% for final exam in April
- Note: When calculated at the end of the course, midterm test marks will be the best of the true midterm mark you received and your final exam mark, *i.e.*, the final exam can replace either or both midterms.
- Important: Do NOT skip the midterm tests. Even if you don't feel well prepared, write them for practice so you are better prepared for writing the final exam.
- If you must miss a midterm (e.g., illness or accepting a Nobel prize), your final exam mark will replace it.

Assignments

- There will be five assignments.
- Each question will have a multiple choice component (on [childsmath](#)). Only participation counts for marks; you will get the same credit for correct and incorrect answers, or for selecting “I haven’t had time to think about this yet”.
- Optionally, full solutions/proofs can be written up and submitted on [crowdmark](#). Feedback will be given, but no marks. The purpose is to help you prepare better for the test and exam.
- If you’re not sure if your proof is complete, or you got stuck and don’t know how to complete it, make that clear in the document that you submit on [crowdmark](#), so the TA can focus on the help you need.
- Always try your best to solve problems on your own first. But if you used stackexchange or ChatGPT or whatever for help, provide a URL or Chat transcript for your source if possible, so it is easier for the TA to provide the help you need.
- Make the best possible use of the TA’s time: say what you think you do or don’t understand.

Assignment 1

- [Assignment 1](#) is posted on the course web site.

Last time...

- Discussed algebra of derivatives and chain rule.
- Proved the chain rule.
- Proved that that derivative is zero at extrema.

The Mean Value Theorem

Theorem (Rolle's theorem)

If f is continuous on $[a, b]$ and differentiable on (a, b) , and $f(a) = f(b)$, then there exists $x \in (a, b)$ such that $f'(x) = 0$.

Proof.

f continuous on $[a, b] \implies f$ has a max and min value on $[a, b]$. If either a max or min occurs at $x \in (a, b)$ then $f'(x) = 0$. If no max or min occurs in (a, b) then they must both occur at the endpoints, a and b . But $f(a) = f(b)$, so f is constant. Hence $f'(x) = 0 \forall x \in (a, b)$. $\square$

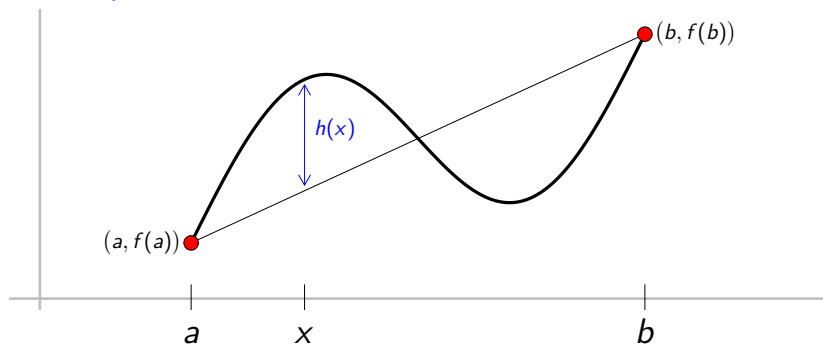
Theorem (Mean value theorem)

If f is continuous on $[a, b]$ and differentiable on (a, b) then there exists $x \in (a, b)$ such that

$$f'(x) = \frac{f(b) - f(a)}{b - a}.$$

The Mean Value Theorem

Idea for proof:



Proof.

Apply [Rolle's theorem](#) to

$$h(x) = f(x) - \left[f(a) + \left(\frac{f(b) - f(a)}{b - a} \right) (x - a) \right].$$



The Mean Value Theorem

Example

$f'(x) > 0$ on an interval $I \implies f$ strictly increasing on I .

Proof:

Suppose $x_1, x_2 \in I$ and $x_1 < x_2$. We must show $f(x_1) < f(x_2)$.

Since $f'(x)$ exists for all $x \in I$, f is certainly differentiable on the closed subinterval $[x_1, x_2]$.

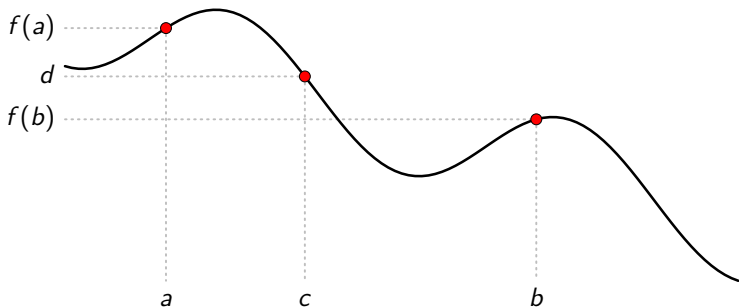
Hence by the [Mean Value Theorem](#) $\exists x_* \in (x_1, x_2)$ such that

$$\frac{f(x_2) - f(x_1)}{x_2 - x_1} = f'(x_*).$$

But $x_2 - x_1 > 0$ and since $x_* \in I$, we know $f'(x_*) > 0$.

$\therefore f(x_2) - f(x_1) > 0$, i.e., $f(x_1) < f(x_2)$. □

REMINDER: Intermediate Value Property



Definition (Intermediate Value Property (IVP))

A function f defined on an interval I is said to have the **intermediate value property (IVP)** on I iff for each $a, b \in I$ with $f(a) \neq f(b)$, and for each d between $f(a)$ and $f(b)$, there exists c between a and b for which $f(c) = d$.

REMINDER: Intermediate Value Property

Theorem (Intermediate Value Theorem (IVT))

*If f is continuous on an interval I then f has the **intermediate value property (IVP)** on I .*

Note: The interval I in the statement of the IVT does not have to be closed and it does not have to be bounded.

Unlike the **extreme value theorem**, the IVT is not a theorem about functions defined on closed and bounded intervals.

Poll

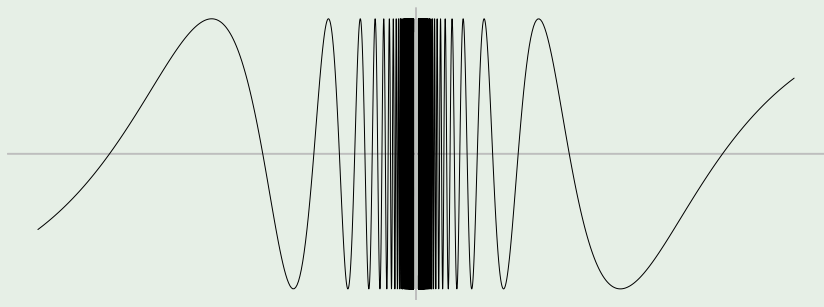
- Go to
https://www.childsmath.ca/childsa/forms/main_login.php
- Click on Math 3A03
- Click on Take Class Poll
- Fill in poll **Derivatives: IVP and derivatives**
- .

Intermediate Value Property

Question: If a function has the **IVP** on an interval I , must it be **continuous** on I ?

Example

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} \sin \frac{1}{x} & x \neq 0, \\ 0 & x = 0. \end{cases}$$



Intermediate value property for derivatives

Theorem (Darboux's Theorem: IVP for derivatives)

If f is differentiable on an interval I then its derivative f' has the intermediate value property on I .

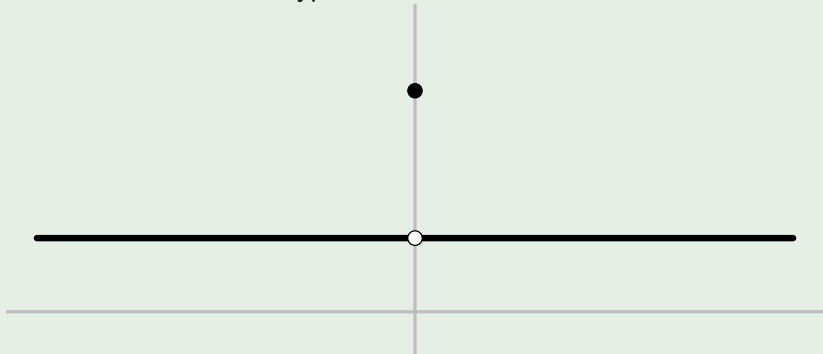
Notes:

- It is f' , not f , that is claimed to have the intermediate value property in Darboux's theorem. This theorem does not follow from the standard intermediate value theorem because the derivative f' is not necessarily continuous.
- *Equivalent (contrapositive) statement of Darboux's theorem:*
If a function does not have the intermediate value property on I then it is impossible that it is the derivative of any function on I .
- Darboux's theorem implies that a derivative cannot have jump or removable discontinuities. Any discontinuity of a derivative must be essential. Recall example of a discontinuous function with IVP.

Intermediate value property for derivatives

Example

What are the different types of discontinuities?



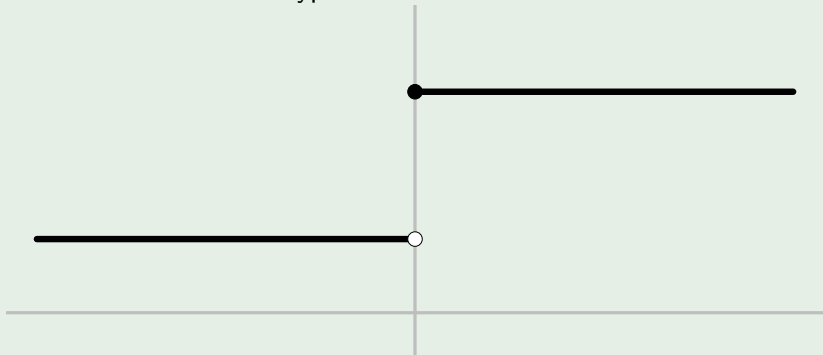
This is a *removable discontinuity*. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0} f(x)$ exists.

The discontinuity can be removed by redefining $f(0)$.

Intermediate value property for derivatives

Example

What are the different types of discontinuities?

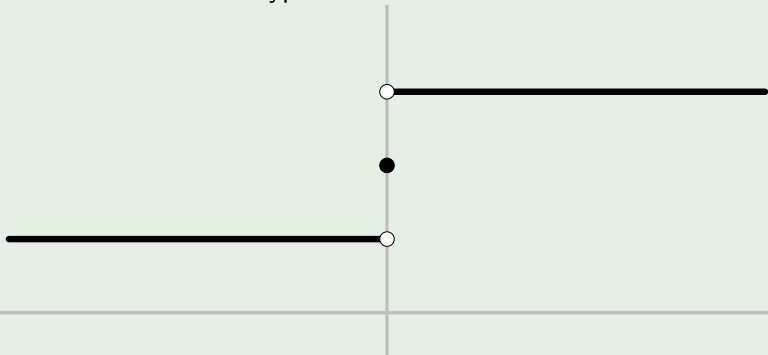


This is a *jump discontinuity*. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^-} f(x) \neq f(0) = \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} f(x)$.

Intermediate value property for derivatives

Example

What are the different types of discontinuities?



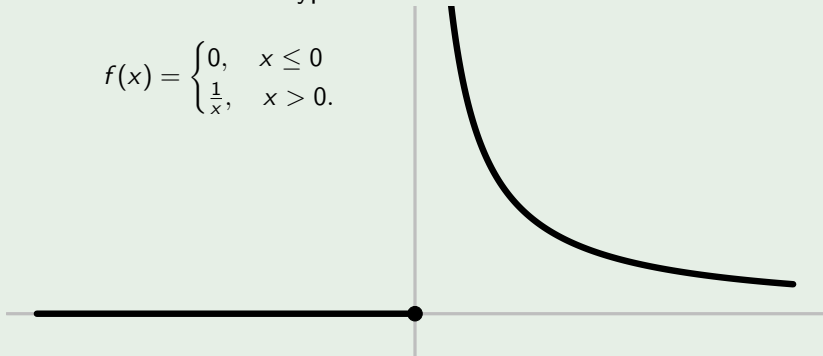
This is a *jump discontinuity*. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^-} f(x) \neq f(0) \neq \lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} f(x)$.

Intermediate value property for derivatives

Example

What are the different types of discontinuities?

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} 0, & x \leq 0 \\ \frac{1}{x}, & x > 0. \end{cases}$$



This is an **essential discontinuity**. $\lim_{x \rightarrow 0^+} f(x)$ does not exist.

This function does not satisfy the **intermediate value property**, so it **cannot** be the derivative of any function.

Intermediate value property for derivatives

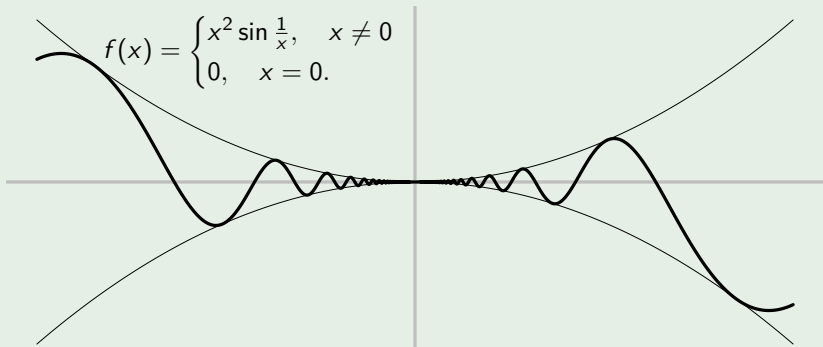
Example

What is an example of a function that is a derivative but is not continuous?

Consider the following differentiable function $f(x)$.

Is its derivative $f'(x)$ continuous?

$$f(x) = \begin{cases} x^2 \sin \frac{1}{x}, & x \neq 0 \\ 0, & x = 0. \end{cases}$$

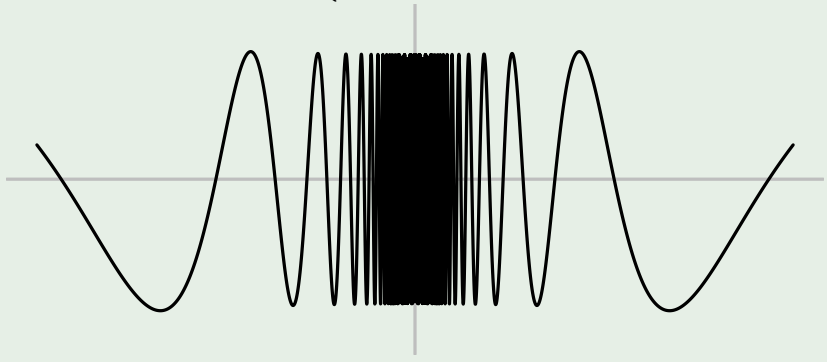


Intermediate value property for derivatives

Example

What is an example of a function that is a derivative but is not continuous? The derivative of $f(x)$ is

$$f'(x) = \begin{cases} 2x \sin \frac{1}{x} - \cos \frac{1}{x} & x \neq 0 \\ 0 & x = 0 \end{cases}$$

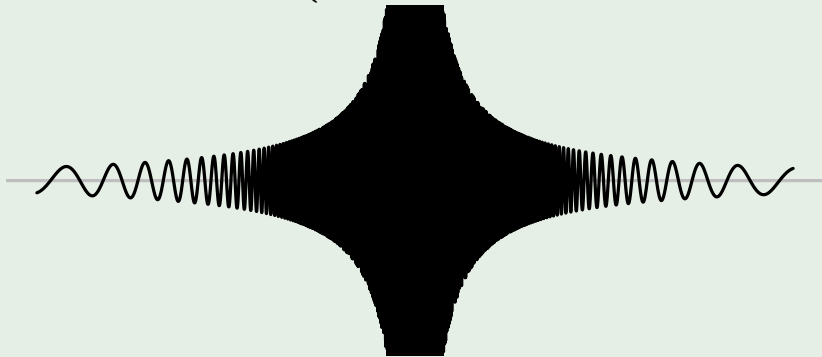


Intermediate value property for derivatives

Example

What about our original example $x^2 \sin \frac{1}{x^2}$? Its derivative is

$$f'(x) = \begin{cases} 2x \sin \frac{1}{x^2} - \frac{2}{x} \cos \frac{1}{x^2} & x \neq 0 \\ 0 & x = 0 \end{cases}$$



$f'(x)$ satisfies the IVP, even though it blows up near 0.

Intermediate value property for derivatives

Proof of Darboux's Theorem.

Consider $a, b \in I$ with $a < b$.

Suppose first that $f'(a) < 0 < f'(b)$. We will show $\exists x \in (a, b)$ such that $f'(x) = 0$. Since f' exists on $[a, b]$, we must have f continuous on $[a, b]$, so the **Extreme Value Theorem** implies that f attains its minimum at some point $x \in [a, b]$. This minimum point cannot be an endpoint of $[a, b]$ ($x \neq a$ because $f'(a) < 0$ and $x \neq b$ because $f'(b) > 0$).

Therefore, $x \in (a, b)$. But f is differentiable everywhere in (a, b) , so, by the **theorem on the derivative at local extrema**, we must have $f'(x) = 0$.

Now suppose more generally that $f'(a) < K < f'(b)$. Let $g(x) = f(x) - Kx$. Then g is differentiable on I and $g'(x) = f'(x) - K$ for all $x \in I$. In addition, $g'(a) = f'(a) - K < 0$ and $g'(b) = f'(b) - K > 0$, so by the argument above, $\exists x \in (a, b)$ such that $g'(x) = 0$, i.e., $f'(x) - K = 0$, i.e., $f'(x) = K$.

The case $f'(a) > K > f'(b)$ is similar. □

Intermediate value property for derivatives

Example $(f'(x) \neq 0 \ \forall x \in I \implies f \nearrow \text{ or } \searrow \text{ on } I)$

If f is differentiable on an interval I and $f'(x) \neq 0$ for all $x \in I$ then f is either increasing or decreasing on the entire interval I .

Proof:

Suppose $\exists a, b \in I$ such that $f'(a) < 0$ and $f'(b) > 0$.

Then, from [Darboux's theorem](#), $\exists c \in I$ such that $f'(c) = 0$. $\Rightarrow \Leftarrow$

$\therefore$ Either " $\exists a \in I \nmid f'(a) < 0$ " is FALSE
or " $\exists b \in I \nmid f'(b) > 0$ " is FALSE.

$\therefore$ Since we know $f'(x) \neq 0 \ \forall x \in I$, it must be that
either $f'(x) > 0 \ \forall x \in I$ or $f'(x) < 0 \ \forall x \in I$,
i.e., either f is increasing on I or decreasing on I . □